

Homework — 1.2.2 Applications Generation

Name: _____ Date: _ **Mark:** ____ / 20

OCR H446 — set after the 1.2.2 lesson. Show your working.

Part A — This week's topic (~14 marks)

1. Classify each of the following as **application software** or **utility software**, and give a one-line reason for each. [3] (AO2)

(a) A file compression tool (b) A presentation package (c) A firewall

2. A school is choosing between **open source** and **closed source (proprietary)** office software. State **two** advantages of choosing open source and **one** advantage of choosing closed source. [3] (AO2)

3. During the **lexical analysis** stage of compilation, what is produced and what is removed? Why is the **symbol table** created at this stage useful to later stages? [3] (AO1)

4. Explain what happens during **code optimisation** and state why this stage is included even though the program would already run without it. [2] (AO1)

5. A large program is built from several compiled modules plus a graphics library. Explain the role of the **loader** when the finished executable is run. [2] (AO1)

6. A games studio updates a shared graphics library after release. Explain why **dynamic linking** lets users benefit from the update without the studio re-releasing the whole program. [1] (AO2)

Part B — Retrieval: keep it fresh (~6 marks)

7. (from 1.2.1) Describe, in order, the steps the CPU and OS take to handle an **interrupt**, making clear why a **stack** is used. [3] (AO1)

8. (from 1.1.2) Explain **one** way in which a **RISC** processor differs from a **CISC** processor. [1] (AO1)

9. (from 1.1.2) State Von Neumann architecture's key principle that distinguishes it from Harvard architecture. [2] (AO1)

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